



TIPS & TRICKS



Is it possible to run commands periodically without *cron*?

Yes, running commands periodically without *cron* is possible by using the *while* loop.

```
# while true; do <your command here> ; sleep 100; done &
```

As an example:

```
# while true; do echo "Hello World" ; sleep 100; done &
```

Do not forget the last '&' as it will make your loop run as a background process.

In the same way, to call a script, create a file named *while_check.sh* with the following content:

```
# cat using_while.sh
#!/bin/bash
```

```
while true; do /bin/sh script.sh ; sleep 100; done &
```

```
# cat script.sh
echo "Hello World"
```

```
# ./using_while.sh
```

You can adjust the sleep time (in seconds) for periodical execution.

—Ranjithkumar T,
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Monitoring real-time session commands of one terminal on multiple terminals

Run the following command on TTY1 (Terminal 1):

```
root@server[~]# mklifo monitor
```

This will create the FIFO file.

Now run the following command on TTY2 (Terminal 2):

```
root@server[~]# cat monitor
```

It shows the live session of TTY1.

Run the following command on TTY1:

```
root@server[~]# script -f monitor
```

This will start recording the session on TTY1 and the real-time session of TTY1 can be viewed on TTY2.

To end the recording, run:

```
exit
```

—Dhananjay Gupte,
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Create and change the directory with a single command

While working in a terminal, we often create a directory and then visit it using the 'cd' command. It would be wonderful if this could be done using a single command. Enter the following bash function in your '~/.bashrc' file or in your '~/.bash_profile'. The script will create a command called *mcd*. The process can be used to make other similar commands that will simplify your life.

```
function mcd()
{
    if [ "$#" -eq 1 ]
    then
        mkdir --parents "$1"
        cd "$1"
    else
        echo "Usage: mcd <DIR_NAME>" > /dev/stderr
    fi
}
```

Now, open a new terminal and type *mcd* with a directory name; for example:

```
mcd my-new-directory
```